# thamesview

Your Magazine From Gallions | gallionsha.co.uk | OCTOBER 2007




**Safety first...**
Our guide to enjoying the Thamesmead waterways safely

**Hop on**
The new accessible bus service

**A new you?**
How to protect yourself from identity fraud

**Fun for all the family!**
8 fantastic activities in your area

**Positive prospects**
Free careers and training support that could change your life

**The Moorings**
An update on the resident consultation

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Gallions Housing Association

# Welcome to your new look Thamesview!

Thank you for unwrapping the latest edition of Thamesview - we really hope you like it! Over the last couple of months we have been busy finding out what Gallions residents and staff think of Thamesview magazine. The feedback we received was really positive but there were a few suggestions to make it even better.

With this in mind, we decided that it was time to give Thamesview a make over. As well as having a new look, this edition is packed full of new and exciting features for you and your family to enjoy. We have included a fantastic pull-out *mini mag just for kids*, that is sure to keep them entertained this half term and beyond. You will also find a *daily life section* with valuable advice and information and an *events calendar* so you know what's happening in your area. We have kept in the old favourites, with more updates from the *Neighbourhood Wardens* and new *puzzles and competitions*.

As always, we would love to hear what you think about Thamesview so please complete the short feedback form on page 15 and return it to us by post or by dropping it in to our office (address details on the form). To celebrate the transformation of the magazine one lucky resident will win £20 in retail vouchers if they return the form by the 12th November 2007.

## Did you know?

The Thamesview editorial team is made up to ten Gallions staff members and three residents. We work together to make sure that Thamesview is a great magazine for all residents. Email **thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk** or call **0208 320 3442** if you would like to get in touch'

Enjoy the magazine and we hope to hear from you soon!

# GRB & more:

## Great ways to get involved

The Gallions Residents Board (GRB) is made up of tenants and charge payers who live in properties owned or managed by Gallions Housing Association. GRB members are elected by residents with the aim of working with Gallions to improve the quality of life for all residents. In the July 2007 elections the following residents were elected to join the GRB:

Iris Atkins, Joanne Bernard, Xiao Ling Chen, Dennis Dixon, James Flynn, Pauline Oates, Yen Quan, Stanley Rider, David Rugg, John Stuart, John Cornelius, Gloria Wray and Terry Wray

Dennis Dixon, Yen Quan and John Cornelius are completely new to the GRB, with the rest of the members either being co-opted last year or re-elected. The new GRB Chair is Dave Jessop and the Vice Chair is Deborah Frimpong.

Becoming a member of the GRB is an excellent way to have your voice heard but there are lots of other opportunities for you to get involved

- Join the Gallions telephone database – we will occasionally contact you for a chat about Gallions' services.The information you provide helps us tailor services to your needs

Plus, each time you take part in a telephone survey Gallions will say 'Thank You' with a £5 voucher!

- Join your Neighbourhood Co-ordinator on a 'Walkabout' of your local area to monitor the quality of the outside space and raise any concerns you may have.**There are more details in the Gallions and You section**
- Become a block or estate representative
- Set up a local Tenants and/ or Residents Association
- Attend focus groups (small one off meetings to give Gallions your views) and interest groups
- Get involved with Gallions Residents Board - even though the elections are over, the GRB are still able to co-opt new members to sit on the GRB until the 2008 Annual General Meeting

If you would like more information about any of these activities please contact Helen Chambers, GRB Officer on freephone **0800 83 84 81 ext 382.**



Aaron Nicholson is the new Neighbourhood Coordinator for the Broadwaters and Manorway areas. To contact Aaron call **0800 83 84 81.**



## Trouble getting about? Try the Hop & Shop Service

Gallions have formed a partnership with the Bexley Accessible Transport Service (BATS) to develop a convenient and cost-effective hop and shop service for residents. BATS is a charity that runs a fleet of accessible, safe and clean minibuses for local voluntary and community groups. Each bus is designed for wheelchair users and drivers are fully trained to assist passengers with mobility difficulties.

The scheme is available for older or disabled residents and parents of children under five. Residents are collected from their homes and transported to local shopping locations, where additional support is made available. Potential users are asked to register to take advantage of the service.

The service currently operates on Tuesdays and Thursdays and has been going since the summer. On one of the first trips members visited Morrison's at Erith who provided wheelchairs, personal assistants and dedicated checkouts. All journeys cost only 50p each way.

Bexley Accessible Transport Service administer the scheme and can supply pre-paid tickets and monthly itineraries.

To register please contact **BATS** on **01322 33 33 77** or call **0800 83 84 81** and speak to a Neighbourhood Warden.

# Extension to the Nail Art course

The Nail Art Project that started over a year ago in Thamesmead is set to expand. Janine, one of our Neighbourhood Wardens, set up the project to teach young ladies (and young men too!) how to apply false nails and become confident in nail decoration. The club has been a huge success and Janine will be running more 12 week classes at Heronsgate youth club at 7pm every other Thursday from September. There are also plans to run the course at the Southlake Centre from January 2008.



The classes are free and open to anyone aged 10-18 years. There's no need to book a place, just turn up and enjoy the fun. For more information please contact the respective youth club or Janine on **0800 83 84 81**

## Junior Warden Scheme a huge success at Parkway Primary School

The Gallions' Neighbourhood Wardens recently took the Junior Warden scheme to Parkway Primary School. The initiative is designed to inform young people about the local area, the Warden's responsibilities and educational topics.

The project ran for six weeks, with a different interactive activity each week. Week one and two focused on taking pride in the community, with hands-on litter picking and graffiti removal sessions. In weeks three and four the students were taught about environmental responsibility. The group visited Tump 53 to learn about the redevelopment of the former nature reserve and had talks about recycling and waste minimisation. The pupils learnt about fire safety at a trip to Erith Fire Station and were able to experience the benefits of physical activity and working as a team at the cAve climbing wall.

The Neighbourhood Wardens will be taking the scheme to Heronsgate school in Thamesmead soon.

## Look out for a JuniorWarden in your area

The Neighbourhood Wardens have been working with local schools to promote street cleanliness. They will be running safe litter picking activities with Thamesmead primary schools over the next few months.

## The Moorings Consultation

Gallions are currently investigating the possibility of regenerating the Moorings area. During this time, the Moorings will not be included within the Decent Homes works schedule, but we will continue to carry out regular maintenance and repair work.

By August 2008, we will decide whether a programme of regeneration will start. If not, we will then carry out the Decent Homes works as planned. To ensure we have as much information as possible before making a decision, Gallions held resident consultation sessions in September to get the views of residents living in the Moorings.

During these sessions, residents completed a questionnaire highlighting what they like and dislike about living in the area, along with their views on how we can improve the area. We still need more of you to give us your views.

So if you live in the Moorings area, look out for details of further sessions and please come along and share your issues and aspirations.

Findings from the consultation so far will be available on our website.

If you require further information call the Neighbourhood Projects

Team on **0800 83 84 81.**

**Please note: No decision as to whether the area will be regenerated or not have been made.**

Gallions have been included in a new publication; Diverse Britain 2007. This hardback book celebrates diversity in the UK today and profiles organisations that reflect social diversity in the way they work. A copy is available for you to read in the reference section of Thamesmead Library, Binsey Walk.

## Thank you

To those of you that made our first Resident's Conference such a success. We received some fantastic feedback and we are currently finalising the conference notes and working hard to resolve any problems you identified. For more information contact Neighbourhoods Projects on **0800 83 84 81.**

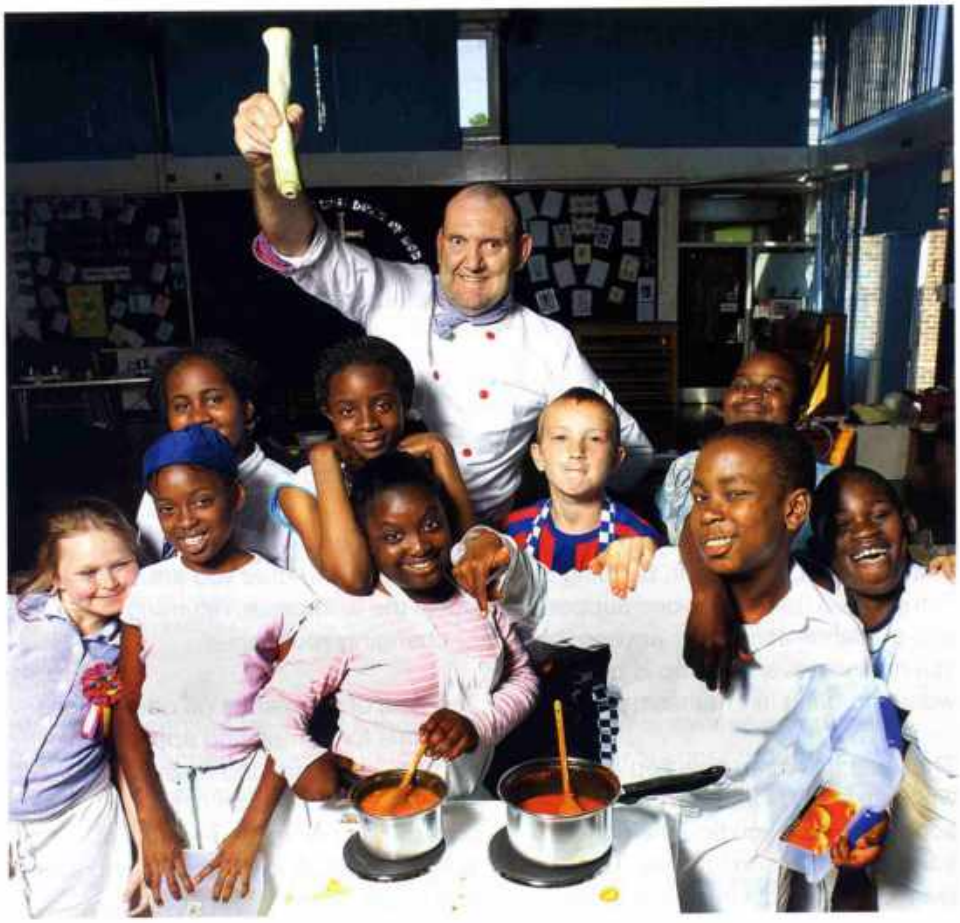
You will find a copy of our Annual Review 2006/07 for residents included with this edition of Thamesview. This document will give you a real insight into how Gallions' have performed over the last year, with key facts and figures for your information.

# The Wardens cook up a storm at local school

Warden Bruce Bishop has had a tasty few months. He has been running a cooking club at St John Fisher primary school to teach young pupils about basic food hygiene and kitchen safety, as well as showing participants how to prepare some delicious healthy snacks. The students are asked to pay for their own ingredients but are able to take their yummy treats home with them.

Eleven pupils finished the course, with the highlight being a 'Best Salad' competition. Warden Phil Briggs judged the competition, which was a tough but scrumptious challenge! The winner, Samuel Folasire was presented with a trophy for his fantastic effort.

The course, which runs for six weeks, will be incorporated into the after school club at Windrush primary school from October.



PROPERTIES AVAILABLE NOW!

# A helping hand onto the property ladder



**In London, a combination of a shortage of homes and rising house prices has contributed to many people struggling to find a home that meets their needs. As house prices in London rise, getting a foot on the property ladder seems harder than ever. Gallions operate a number of government funded schemes aimed at helping you to buy your own home. Two of our popular schemes are NewBuild HomeBuy and Social HomeBuy.**

### New Build HomeBuy

New Build HomeBuy is a part buy, part rent scheme. It is partly funded by the government and aims to help first time buyers. It is designed as a stepping stone to buying your home completely, allowing you to buy what you want when you can afford it. Most homes are newly built but sometimes older properties that are refurbished are available. If you are not able to buy a home on the open market, then this scheme could be for you.

Gallions also have a number of resale opportunities – these are part buy, part rent properties which the existing shared owner now wishes to sell.

### Social HomeBuy

This scheme allows social housing tenants to buy their current home either outright or by shared ownership with the benefit of the discount. The minimum share you can purchase will be 25% and the property can be bought outright, with a maximum discount of £16,000 depending on the initial share purchased.

The scheme allows you to stop paying rent and become a homeowner! You will need to be an existing secure or assured tenant of Gallions and will need to also meet the current eligibility requirements for this scheme.

For more details about either of our schemes please call the Home Ownership Team: **0800 731 4587**

# Tons of training choices with Trust Thamesmead

Trust Thamesmead's training and employment department, Building Futures, is a free one-to-one support and guidance service for anyone (but you must be over 16) who is out of work and living in Thamesmead.

The Trust has three qualified advisors who can provide individually-tailored support to help you find the right training course and job role. The team can offer lots of advice about all aspects of career training and progression whether you are starting out in the workplace, returning to work or changing your career.

The type of assistance on offer ranges from tips for completing application forms to childcare and travel to work support. The team can help you access free training in a variety of subjects, including IT, hairstyling, retail and much more.

The Building Futures Team can also help employers to find staff, fill work placement openings and access training programmes for their employees.

If you'd like to find out more please visit Sharron, Graham or Ingrid at the Trust Thamesmead office, call them on **0208 320 4470** or **email buildingfutures@trust-thamesmead.co.uk**

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

# Identity crisis

Your identity and personal information are valuable. If criminals have access to your personal details they can use them to open bank accounts, get credit, claim state benefits and apply for passports and driving licenses in your name. There are numerous methods criminals use to steal your identity, including taking documents from your rubbish, intercepting your mail or by making contact with you and pretending to be from a legitimate organisation.
To minimise the risk of fraud you should:

- Destroy or shred any printed material with personal or banking details
- If you move house, inform your bank, card issuer and all other organisations that you deal with immediately. Ask the Royal Mail to redirect any mail from your old address to your new one for at least a year
- Be extra careful if you live in a property where other people could have access to your mail
- Never give personal or account details to anyone who contacts you unexpectedly. Be suspicious even if they claim to be from your bank or the police. A bank will never ask for your PIN or for a whole security number or password

If you suspect your mail is being stolen, contact the Royal Mail Customer Enquiry Line: **08457 740 740**.
You can get more information from the Home Office at **www.identity-theft.org.uk**

# Staying safe around our waterways



Thamesmead benefits from an abundance of lakes, canals and green open spaces, which all help to create a more balanced environment for us to enjoy. However, our waterways can be dangerous places for children and adults alike.

We have compiled a list of safety guidelines below to ensure that you and your family can enjoy the lakes and canals and stay safe. We have also included an educational game and competition in the new Kidsview section of the magazine so take time to read through the safety advice with your children.

## Waterways safety tips

- Children should always be accompanied by an adult when visiting lakes, canals or any stretch of deepwater
- Never dive into canals or shallow water
- Make sure you let others know if you visit waterways
- Encourage family members to take swimming lessons or other water safety programs if they are not strong swimmers
- Don't run around near the water's edge; you could trip and fall in
- If you spot anyone in danger; call for emergency services help quickly. If there is a lifebuoy or other life saving equipment around, throw it for the person to catch while you wait for help. Do not go in and try to rescue them as you may run into difficulties too
- Ensure that you read and pay attention to danger or information signs placed around waterways
- Do not walk onto frozen waterways, the ice may not be thick enough to hold your weight
- Vandalism puts lives at risk. Destroying or stealing life saving equipment means that they will not be available when needed. If you see anyone vandalising safety equipment, report them to the police
- If you go in a boat or canoe, make sure everyone onboard wears a life jacket

We have recently carried out a thorough inspection of our waterways network and have arranged for new signage to be put up. Our Neighbourhood Wardens will also be visiting schools in the coming months to provide advice and give out a special waterways safety booklet.

For more information about staying safe around our waterways go to **www.rospa.com/waterandleisuresafety**

SPOTLIGHT ON

## Greenmead Children's Centre

Since its launch in March 2007 Greenmead Children's Centre has been going from strength to strength. The centre offers a wide range of activities for parents, carers and young children.

There are sessions you'd expect to see at a Children's Centre like baby group and tots to toddlers, as well as unusual courses like food hygiene and career training especially for adults. The team also cater for families with specific needs; sessions are available by self-referral or referral from your health visitor. After school is finished, the centre offers dancercise and arts and crafts classes for children up to the age of 8 (a small fee applies).

This half term staff will be running a special coffee morning on the 26th October. At the end of the month, the team will be introducing the exciting 'got kids, get reading' programme.

To sign up for some fun please contact Carmel or Linda on **0208 320 1618** or pop in to **Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, Erith, DA18 4HW**

Every issue we will be focusing on one group in the area. If you'd like us to shine the spotlight on what you do then please get in touch (details on the welcome page). Contact us too if you want to list your group or provide us with updates.

## For little ones (under 5)

**Goose-e-ganders Parent and ToddlerGroup,** Broadwater Village Hall, telephone 07958 640645

**Toddles, Manor Close Community Hall,** Manor Close, telephone 0208 310 9004

**Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School,** Senior Citizens Hall, Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853481

**Lighthouse Parent and Toddler Group,** Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and Fridays 1.30pm until 3pm.

**Toy Library, Linton Mead primary school,** Central Way, telephone 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time only, for under 5s.

## For bigger ones

**The Cave Climbing wall,** Arch 3, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 320 4494, web trust-thamesmead-cave.co.uk, Monday to Friday 4pm until 7pm and weekends 1.30pm until 5.30pm, for under 18s.

**Fun Club,** Glimpsing Green, telephone 0208 311 6777, Saturday mornings, for under 11s with a disability.

**JMF Support Group,** Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 310 5885, Saturday 1pm until 3pm

**Rainbows,** Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for 5 to 7 year olds.

**Rainbows,** Abbey Wood Community Centre, 4 Knee Hill, telephone 0208 311 2239, Wednesday 4.45pm until 6pm, for 5 to 7 year olds

**Brownies and Guides,** Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for girls aged 7+.

**New Acres Library,** Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5291, for all young people, from babies to teenagers.

**Hawksmoor Youth Club,** Bentham Road, telephone 0208 312 4022

**Heronsgate Youth Club,** Whinchat Road, 07950 612826

## Performing Arts

**Dynamix,** Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 07796 450093, for ages 8 to 19

**Theatre Street,** Broadwater Village Hall, Gooseander Way, telephone 01322 441977, web theatrestreet.com, tots to adults

**Youth Advisory Project,** Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 311 5111, for 16 to 24 year olds

## Young at Heart

**Monday Club Bingo,** Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

**Over 50s Bingo Club,** Chubby Brown's Café, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7.30pm until 9pm

**Pop in Parlour, Evenlode House,** Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

**The Atrium**, Teeswater Court, telephone 0208 333 2002, 7 days a week

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

# Events Calendar

There are exciting things happening in your area. Below you will find details of free or low cost local events, perfect for a family day out and key diary dates.

## October 07

### End of British Summer Time 28 Oct

Enjoy an extra hour in bed and turn clocks back by an hour

### Black History Month 1- 31 Oct

This year Black History Month celebrates the bicentenary of the abolition of the slave trade. Trust Thamesmead will be holding a photojournalism exhibition entitled 'Descendants of all Worlds' throughout the month. The free exhibition is open 9am until 5pm, Monday to Friday and will be based in the reception area of the Trust Thamesmead office.

Need More Details? Call Trust Thamesmead on **020 8320 4470.**

### Chung Yeung (Chinese) 19 Oct

### Tudor Toys Workshop 20 Oct

At Charlton House this half term you can learn how to make simple Tudor toys. The workshops are free and suitable for children aged 5+, who must be accompanied by an adult at all times.

Need more details? Visit www.greenwich.gov.uk/Greenwich/LeisureCulture/EntertainmentEvents or call **020 8854 8888**.

### Energy Saving Week 22-28 Oct

Energy Saving Week is a great time to think about your impact on the environment. There are lots of easy ways you can reduce your energy consumption, saving you money and helping prevent climate change.

Need more details? Visit www.energysavingtrust.org.uk or www.gallionsha.co.uk for top energy saving tips. You can also call free energy saving trust advice line on **0800 512012.**

## November 07

### Fireworks Display 3 Nov

Celebrate Bonfire Night on Blackheath or at Danson Park with a fantastic free firework display.

Need more details? Call Greenwich Council on **0208 314 7430** or Bexley Council on **020 8303 7777.**

### Diwali (Hindu, Jain and Sikh) 9 Nov

### Auction of Promises 10 Nov

Second Belvedere Brownies will be holding an Auction of Promises to raise money for new games equipment. The auction, being held at St Augustine's church hall in Belvedere, begins at 6.30pm and is free and open to all. Prizes include beauty hampers and homemade cakes.

Need more details? Call Brown Owl on **01322 440 071.**

### Remembrance Sunday 11 Nov

### Christmas Bazaar 17 Nov

Why not plan early and visit the Christmas Bazaar being held at Smerdon Resource Centre, Lumley Close in Belvedere. The Bazaar is open between 12 noon and 3pm and costs only 20p to attend. There will be a Santa onsite, handmade cards and specialist items.

Need more details? Call Smerdon Resource Centre on **01322 432 212**

### Eltham Farmers Market 18 Nov

Discover some new flavours at Eltham Farmers Market. There will be a range of fresh produce and arts and crafts products available for you to purchase. Bring along the family and have a great day out.

Need more details? Call Greenwich Council on **0208 850 6435**

### St Andrews Day concert 30 Nov

Trinity College of Music are offering a free concert to mark St Andrews Day at Charlton House. Expect marvellous music and Scottish specialities.

Need more details? Call Greenwich Council on **0208 850 6435**

# Events Calendar



December 07

## Christmas Masks Workshop 8 Dec

Learn the art of disguise at this mask workshop at Charlton House. This event is free and open to children aged 5+ with an accompanying adult. Make a fantastic Christmas mask to take home with you for the festive season. Need more details? Call Charlton House on **0208 856 3951.**

## Gallions and GRB Over 65s Christmas Party 13 Dec

Get into the festive spirit by coming along to the Atrium this December. Enjoy mince pies, mulled wine, carols and great company. For more information contact the Neighbourhood Wardens on **0800 83 84 81**

## Gallions Festive Opening Times 24, 25, 26, 31 December and 1st January

Our Harrow Manorway office will be closed on these dates. However, our contact centre will be open to take your calls and Team Gallions will be offering a skeleton service. On all other days we will be providing our normal service.

## For details of lots more fun events during the festive season visit our website www.gallionsha.co.uk

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any events listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

Gallions Housing Association tw magazine

# Just for Fun!

Take some time out to enjoy our brainteasers.




## 1 Linking up

Use the clues and change one letter each time to turn the word 'wrap' into 'bait'. We have done the first one for you to help.

**WRAP**
***TRAP*** **a device used to capture something**
TRIP **to fall or stumble**
GRIP **to grasp or hold**
GRIT **pieces of stone or sand**
GRIT **a person from Britain**
**BAIT**

## 2 Anagrams

These familiar words have been jumbled up – can you work out what they should say?
We have given you clues to help.

**Weave smith - A great title**
WEATHERVIEW
**A new hello - Trick or Treat?**
HALLOWEEN
**Ham next oil – Our new children's mascot**

## 3 Wordsearch

On the 5th November it is Bonfire night so our wordsearch is all about Guy Fawkes and his plot. Complete the wordsearch and you could win £25 in WHSmith vouchers.

**Gunpowder** ✓
**Parliament** ✓
**King** ✓
**Bonfire** ✓
**London** ✓
**Conspiracy** ✓
**Treason** ✓
**Fireworks** ✓
**Plot** ✓
**Penny for the guy** ✓

| S | L | E | F | H | D | E | R | I | F | N | O | B | Y |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| C | L | W | O | N | D | G | T | C | Z | X | D | U | H |
| G | U | N | P | O | W | D | E | R | I | N | G | T | H |
| C | V | F | R | G | H | J | U | I | M | E | V | T | D |
| O | D | S | I | L | W | H | G | F | H | I | R | B | F |
| N | M | L | M | H | E | L | U | T | O | E | N | B | I |
| S | E | K | I | N | G | N | R | I | A | T | E | A | R |
| P | T | H | N | J | K | O | F | S | G | H | Y | H | E |
| I | F | D | S | G | F | T | O | T | H | E | K | N | W |
| R | E | F | T | Y | Y | N | O | R | P | I | N | K | O |
| A | S | D | N | G | H | O | J | N | L | V | C | F | R |
| C | H | N | I | Y | Q | D | Q | W | O | N | Z | S | K |
| Y | E | S | E | E | I | N | G | M | T | I | P | X | S |
| P | L | E | A | S | X | O | V | B | N | H | K | I | U |
| Q | W | E | R | T | F | L | K | H | F | S | R | T | Y |
| Y | G | H | J | T | N | E | M | A | I | L | R | A | P |

Please return your completed wordsearch, along with your details to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, SE2 9XH or drop your entry into our reception by 12th November. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

.....

.....

Email: .....

Telephone: .....

Congratulations to Heidi Ludford of New Acres Road who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Answers: Linking up - Wrap, trap, trip, grip, grit, brit, bait
Anagrams - Tiramesview, Halloween, Max the Lion

# Keeping our staff safe



In light of the recent smoking ban, Gallions has assessed the health and safety policy for staff and contractors that visit clients in their homes. Gallions have a responsibility to protect their staff at work and want to make sure that every member of the organisation stays safe and well. Below are a number of recommendations for residents and staff that will help minimise health risks:

- Staff must not smoke in a client's home
- Service users or clients are asked not to smoke directly prior to or during a visit
- Service users or clients are asked to limit their smoking to rooms where meetings are not regularly held
- Service users and clients are asked to open windows if they have been smoking

If we follow these guidelines we can help residents and staff stay healthy. For more information about the smokefree legislation visit: **smokefreeengland.co.uk.**

Talk to the Team

# What do you think about our repairs service?

Recently, Mr Gower of Kentlea Road spoke to the Thamesview team about the excellent all round service he had received from the repairs and maintenance team. When Mr Gower's disabled access lift broke down he called Gallions and received a really professional and friendly service. The contact centre staff logged his call and arranged for a repair visit. The representative from Axis came out very quickly and completed the job speedily with little disruption to Mr Gower and his family. Mr Gower was particularly impressed with one member of the Axis team who showed real dedication in fixing his lift after his shift was finished.

This November marks the fifth anniversary of the Axis and Gallions working partnership. Since the partnership started Axis have renewed 570 kitchens and 628 bathrooms, carried out 581 electrical rewires, fitted double glazing in 380 properties and laid 391 new roofs, as well as 75,000 responsive repairs. A recent national survey showed that Gallions' residents were extremely pleased with the service they received, with satisfaction levels well above those of other housing associations.



To report repairs at any time call **0800 83 84 81**

# Stamping out anti-social behaviour

As you may have noticed we have posted some signs regarding anti-social behaviour in our reception at Harrow Manor Way and other offices. Although the majority of residents that visit our office, come along to meetings or chat to staff working in the local area are a pleasure to deal with, some can be abusive. Gallions staff have the right to carry out their duties without fear of violence or harassment and we will not tolerate anti-social behaviour directed at staff. Gallions will take action against individuals that display unacceptable conduct.

## Did you Know...

You can get money advice from the citizen's advice bureau at our Harrow Manorway office? If you are worried about debt drop in on Monday and Friday from 9.30am until 10.30am to receive free support and guidance.

# The right call

Gallions want to make it easy for you to get in touch so we operate our customer contact centre 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year. Plus, it's free to call us from land lines on **0800 83 84 81.**

Our team of specially trained advisors are there to help you deal with repair emergencies as well as assisting with general enquiries.

We do experience busy periods and during these times some customers find that they have to wait longer than usual for their calls to be answered. To make sure that you get through to us quickly, try and make non-urgent calls during our quieter times.

The best times to call are: Evenings (after 6pm), weekends and Fridays



# Gas safety

We take our commitment to gas safety seriously and insist that all gas appliances, fittings and flues that we own and you use are serviced annually. These checks take about half an hour depending on the number of our gas appliances in your home. Gas appliances that are not regularly serviced can become costly to run and even dangerous to you and those living nearby.

It is vital that you allow our contractors (Interserve Facilities Services) access to have the servicing done. We will take court action if you refuse entry for safety checks and any costs incurred will be passed on to you (including the cost of missed appointments). If you are a Gallions Housing Association tenant and you are aware that your boiler has not been serviced in the last year, please telephone Carol Rayner on 0208 320 3559 or the Customer Contact team on **0800 83 84 81** to make an appointment as soon as possible .

# Protecting our residents

In August, Dartford County Court awarded Gallions with a possession order against a resident who defrauded BT of £10,000.

The tenant tapped into BT phone lines on a number of occasions, enabling her to make calls without paying. This action not only severely disrupted services to other residents in her block but also caused their phone charges to increase considerably.

Gallions, BT and other residents worked closely over several months to investigating the matter and obtaining evidence of the offender accessing service areas and re-wiring BT lines.

Gallions always investigate when conditions of a tenancy are breached and will take legal action where appropriate.

We can supply this document in any other language. Please fill in the form bellow or pop into our Harrow Manor Way office

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਜਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਉ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nói chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

Punjabi○ Chinese○ Vietnamese○
(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

_____

Return to: Anita Dagger, Translation Requests,
Gallions Housing Association,
Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

# affordable homes

a selection of apartments available to buy through the New Build HomeBuy Scheme (Part Buy, Part Rent)



## trident house

west thamesmead

2 bed apartment
50% share of as property valued at £160,000
3 bed apartment
45% share of a property valued at £200,000



## paradise path

thamesmead

2 bed apartment
50% share of a property valued at £155,000



## the college quarter

woolwich

5 x 1 bed wheelchair accessible apartments
10 x 1 bed apartments
shares available to buy from 40%



## murray close

west thamesmead

2 bed apartment with a garden
55% share of a property valued at £175,000



## park view

orpington

2 bed apartment
55% share of a property valued at £220,000



## st. josephs court

coming soon!

upper belvedere

21 x 1 bed apartments
16 x 2 bed apartments
shares available to buy from 50%

To view call

**0800 731 4587**

Email homes@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk

Gallions Housing Association

prices and availability correct at time of print

There are exciting things happening in your area. Below you will find key diary dates and details of local events.

**08 Holocaust Photos Exhibition**
**2-31 Jan**

**08 Shrove Tuesday**
**5 Feb**

Join Trust Thamesmead for a Pancake Race in the

tails? Contact Trust Thamesmead on

## e New Year

ling of the Chinese New Year with a visit uare, Chinatown and Trafalgar Square. ails? Visit www.london.gov.uk

## nes Day

new and exciting ways to stay fit and ommunity health fair.
ails? Call Greenwich Council on **0208**
fair will be held at Glyndon Community an Road, Plumstead, SE18 7LB between

## Fair



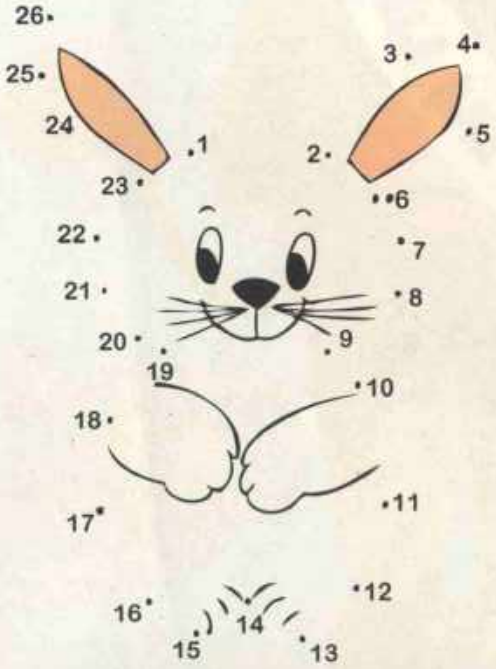
# HAPPY NEW YEAR!

HELLO AGAIN! WELCOME BACK TO MY COMIC. I HOPE YOU HAD A BRILLIANT CHRISTMAS AND ARE STILL HAVING FUN WITH YOUR NEW TOYS. I HAD A GREAT TIME AND I'M LOOKING FORWARD TO AN EXCITING 2008. IN THIS COMIC THERE ARE MORE FANTASTIC GAMES AND PUZZLES FOR YOU TO ENJOY AND SOME IDEAS ABOUT WHAT TO DO DURING HALF TERM AND BEYOND.

DON'T FORGET TO EMAIL ME AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK TO SHARE YOUR STORIES AND PICTURES. THERE ARE SOME REALLY EXCELLENT DRAWINGS AND STORIES ON MY PAGE AT WWW.GALLIONSHA.CO.UK SO CHECK THEM OUT!

## Fun Comes First!

**Join the dots to work out what this picture is. I'll give you a clue - he'll visit you in March with chocolate eggs!**




## Word hunt

**How many smaller words can you make out of the larger word below? I've given you a few ideas to get you started.**

**Valentine – tin, neat, tail, .....**

.....

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## Puzzle Time



**Can you crack this inter-galactic crossword puzzle? It's quite tough so you might like to ask an adult to help you. The answers are at the bottom of the page but no cheating!**



**Across**

1. You might see it shining in the sky at night
3. They fly in UFOs and live on another planet
5. The planet nearest to the sun
7. Where we all live
8. Made up of rock and ice, this object is sometimes seen whizzing through the sky
10. Saturn has these but you might also have them on your fingers
12. The first man on the moon; ____ Armstrong

**Down**

2. It takes a year for the earth to move around the sun in an _____
3. A person that travels into space
4. The number of known planets
6. Spacemen travel in this to get to the moon
9. A film about aliens on earth
11. If you are famous people might call you a ____

Gallions Housing Association

Answers: 1. Moon 3. Aliens 5. Mercury 7. Earth 8. Comet 10. Rings 12. Neil Down 2. Orbit 3. Astro- naut 4. Nine 6. Rocket 9. Men in Black 11. Star

Join Trust Tha

Thamesm
at the

/ a lovely lunch, great c
come along to the Pop
esmead Age Concern
the over 55s, includin

h and tasty lunches se
y weekday. Prices star

o on Monday and Wed
9:30pm

every Wednesday fron
start from £1.00

g each Thursday from
g green are also welco

esmead Age Concern
s and mini breaks for m
Parlour crowd visited t
ford. Gallions provided
Bus for the journey.

the fun please contact Mr T
t the Pop-in Parlour on 020
e Walk, Thamesmead, SE2

will be
group in the area. If y
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elcome page). Conta
or provide us with u

es

**ers Parent and Tod**
ge Hall, telephone 07

**r Close Communit**
310 9004

**Tavy Bridge Pre-Sch**
, telephone 07950 85

**rent and Toddler Group,** Emmanuel
phone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and
until 3pm.

**tions Pre-School**, Emmanuel Church
0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday
noon.

**inton Mead primary school,** Central
0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am,
or under 5s.

**hildren's Centre**, Greenmead Community
Erith, telephone 0208 320 1618




**Max wants you to stay happy, healthy and safe in 2008 so fill in this quiz to find out how he looks after himself. Use the words below to fill in the blanks. Max accidently left an extra word in the list so if you find out what it is write it on the entry form with your name, address and phone number. Return your form by 18th February for the chance to win a family ticket to the cAve indoor climbing wall, donated by Trust Thamesmead.**

**Choose from these words to complete the sentences:**

**parents | exercises | bus | strangers | football | vegetables**

**Max wants to keep fit and healthy so he _____ regularly with friends and family.**

**Max never talks to _____.**

**Max's favourite sports are swimming and _____.**

**It is important to get vitamins so Max eats lots of fruit and _____.**

**Max always plays where his _____ can see him.**

THE cAve
*a dynamic climbing experience*

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

## GREAT THINGS TO DO

THERE ARE LOTS OF EXCITING ACTIVITIES HAPPENING IN YOUR TOWN SOON. WHY NOT JOIN IN?

**Get active in the town centre by joining in with the Trust Thamesmead pancake race. It's sure to be lots of fun.**

**For grown ups: The race will take place on Shrove Tuesday, 5th February. Contact Trust Thamesmead on 0208 320 4470 for more details.**

**Don't forget Mother's Day this year. It's a great time to treat your mum and show her how special she is. Why not make your own card and gift? There are lots of ideas on the Kidsview online pages on our website www.gallionsha.co.uk**

**For grown ups: Mother's Day is on Sunday 2nd March.**

**Are you a great singer, dancer or entertainer? Then enter Trust Thamesmead's talent contest, the T Factor for the chance to perform at the Trust Thamesmead Festival this July!**

**For grown ups: Applications should be sent to Danny Thorpe, Trust Thamesmead, 19a Joyce Dawson Way, Thamesmead town centre, SE28 8RA by Friday 21st March. You can call 0208 320 4470 to find out more.**

Please return your completed form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH or drop your entry into our reception by 18th February. The winner will be selected at random.

Missing Word: _____ Name: _____ _____ Name of parent or guardian: _____ _____

Address: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ Telephone: _____ _____

Congratulations to GEORGE TOWNLEY OF HARTSLOCK DRIVE who was selected as the winner of our last competition!
This competition is open to children under 16 years of age and is free to enter.

tax return and finalise
your tax credits by 31

**856 3951**. The fair will be held at Glyndon Community Centre, 75 Raglan Road, Plumstead, SE18 7LB between 11am and 3pm

## Young at Heart

**Monday Club Bingo,** Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

**Over 50s Bingo Club,** Chubby Brown's Café, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7.30pm until 9pm

**Pop in Parlour, Evenlode House,** Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

**The Atrium**, Teeswater Court, telephone 0208 333 2002, 7 days a week

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.